

# Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager building earn products in self-custody crypto.*

*Positioning*, Product manager with 13 years in regulated industries who has shipped fintech, payments, and security products, and trades and builds in crypto daily.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

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## § WHY LEDGER

The Earn scope sits at a real intersection: self-custody users who want yield, a hardware device that has to stay trustworthy, and a regulatory environment that punishes shortcuts. That combination demands a PM who can negotiate rev-share with staking partners in the morning and write a compliance-ready PRD in the afternoon. The job description calls this out explicitly, "regulatory sensitivity of yield-generating products", and that is the kind of constraint I find useful rather than inconvenient. *That is exactly the environment where tight cross-functional alignment separates shipped product from stuck roadmaps.*

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## § HONEST FRAMING

Ledger Live and the embedded software layer between app and hardware device is a specific stack I have not shipped in before. My device-side depth comes from security product ownership at Qcrypt AG, not consumer hardware wallets. The cross-functional coordination pattern, PM bridging app, device firmware, and embedded software, is one I have run at scale, at Rohde & Schwarz across 15+ engineers in a safety-critical environment.

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## § AI-NATIVE STACK

*Daily tools, not buzzwords.*

- **Claude Code**, in-repo work and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, code review and pair-writing
- **Cursor/VSCoDe**, daily development environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy mockups
- **GPT**, research and edge-case generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, decision-ready documentation

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## § TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

*Shipped with, not just listed.*

PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD with Jenkins, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Matomo.

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## § SIDE PROJECT

CRYPTO BACKTESTING AND TRADING INFRASTRUCTURE [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

*Personal infrastructure for crypto market analysis, algo strategy development, and cross-venue execution.*

- Builds and runs a backtesting engine for crypto strategies, covering perpetual futures and spot across CEX and DEX venues.
- Routes live execution through Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, 1inch, and Across Protocol, with liquidation heatmap analysis via Coinglass and Hyblock Capital.
- Applies microstructure analysis: slippage, price impact, routing quality, and risk sizing as first-class metrics.
- Directly relevant to Earn: understanding execution quality and incentive mechanics at the infrastructure layer is the same reasoning required for staking and yield partner evaluation.

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## § HOW I WOULD WORK AT LEDGER

*First weeks, concrete.*

### WEEK 1

#### **Listen, map, find the gaps.**

Sit with the data in Mixpanel to understand where users drop off in the current Earn funnel, and talk to the engineers and design lead to map what the app-to-device handshake actually costs in terms of scope and lead time.

### WEEK 2

#### **Audit partner coverage.**

Walk the existing staking and yield partner integrations, identify which rev-share terms are up for renegotiation, and flag the one or two gaps in asset or chain coverage that the data points to most clearly.

### WEEK 3+

#### **Ship the first slice.**

Pick the highest-confidence improvement from the funnel analysis, write the PRD, align Legal and Compliance early, and move it through engineering toward a first measurable outcome.

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## **I** COVER LETTER

Dear Ledger team,

Ledger's Earn scope is exactly the kind of product I want to own. Millions of users already trust Ledger devices with custody. The next step, helping them put those assets to work without giving up that custody, is a genuine value proposition, not a feature bolt-on. The challenge is delivering yield products that clear a high regulatory bar, integrate cleanly with the hardware layer, and still feel simple enough that a non-technical user finishes the flow.

I have 13 years of product ownership in regulated environments. At EMIL Group I shipped an insurance claims platform from concept to production and restructured an 18-person delivery organisation that was losing engineers and client trust. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national analytics platform as Deputy IT Security Officer, ran a full ETL migration, and cut data update time by 75%. At Rohde & Schwarz I drove a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers on a safety-critical AI and data platform, instrumented competing workflows to make a prioritisation call with evidence, and got rollout time from days to 30 minutes. In every case the job was the

same: understand what users actually need, align engineering, compliance, and leadership behind a plan, and ship something that can be measured.

On the crypto side, I am not a casual observer. I actively trade perpetual futures and spot across Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, and 1inch, use Coinglass and Hyblock Capital for market microstructure analysis, and have built a backtesting engine and live trading infrastructure in my own time. I understand staking mechanics, bridge risk, DEX routing, and the incentive structures that yield partners bring to a negotiation. I also co-founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a P2P payments product that was acquired and operated inside the Sparkasse girocard ecosystem, so I know what it takes to get a financial product past a compliance team and into production. That combination, fintech delivery experience plus hands-on crypto infrastructure knowledge, is what makes the Earn PM role a natural fit rather than a stretch.

I use AI tooling throughout my workflow: Claude Code for in-repo work, Lovable for rapid prototyping, n8n for agentic automation. I can produce roadmaps, PRDs, and decision-ready dashboards that go straight to leadership without editing, because I have had to do exactly that in every role.

I would be glad to talk through how I would approach the Earn roadmap and partner evaluation. Four weeks' notice from offer.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

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## *II* CURRICULUM VITAE

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### § PROFILE

Senior Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries including fintech, payments, insurance, public-sector analytics, and defence AI. Deep Web3 and crypto domain knowledge: 8 years as an active market participant across CEX and DEX venues, with hands-on work in staking mechanics, perpetual futures, DEX routing, and yield infrastructure. I run continuous discovery, translate strategy and user research into prioritised roadmaps, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery.

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### § HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.

- On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
  - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
  - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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## § WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE |  
07/2024-05/2025

*Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and Data platform for the FCAS European programme.*

- Championed GitOps delivery and test automation with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes across multinational teams, making the platform hotfix-capable.
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.
- Led a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT, NUREMBERG /  
REMOTE | 05/2023-07/2024

*Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.*

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023-07/2023

*Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.*

- Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital information system workflows: digital anamnesis went from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022-12/2022

*Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.*

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from a near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent, and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to less than a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021-03/2022

*Retail and payments, POS and forecourt systems.*

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021-06/2021

- Government, secure data platform. Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019-05/2020

*Health Insurance, B2B procurement webshop.*

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG | 04/2019-12/2019

- Wind energy, full site IT modernisation end to end.

PRODUCT OWNER, WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN, ISNY | 08/2017-06/2018

- Healthcare, clinical network. Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

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## § FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025-06/2026

- Construction staffing, two-sided B2B marketplace. Zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, LLM agents across the funnel. Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN |  
01/2016-12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption hardware and software. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO, SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES, BERLIN |  
03/2018-08/2021

- Nanotechnology and agriculture. Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds, owning financial planning and investor reporting.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN |  
02/2013-11/2018

- Fintech, mobile group-based P2P payments. Built from zero and taken to acquisition: acquired and operated by Sparkasse, inside the girocard ecosystem.

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## § SKILLS

**Product Management:** crypto and Web3 domain knowledge (staking, DEX, perpetuals, bridges, yield mechanics), continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, PRD writing, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, go-to-market support, Mixpanel, Matomo, funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition.

**Product Ownership:** requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, backlog refinement, sprint planning, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

**Agile and Scaled Delivery:** Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning.

**Analytics and Data:** ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, SQL, MicroStrategy, funnel analysis.

**Technical Environments Owned:** Kubernetes, Docker, GitOps with ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps.

**AI Products and Tooling:** LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, Framer, n8n.

**Governance and Compliance:** GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, Insurance regulatory environment, budget ownership and financial planning as CFO.

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## § EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006-09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

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## § LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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